

Product Requirements Document (PRD)

CA Practice Management Software

1. Product Overview

The CA Practice Management Software is a cloud-based operational management platform designed specifically for Chartered Accountant firms, tax consultants, compliance firms, and accounting service providers in India. The primary objective of the platform is to digitize and automate the operational workflows involved in managing clients, statutory compliances, recurring filings, task assignments, document collection, approvals, employee coordination, and compliance tracking.

Traditionally, most CA firms rely heavily on Excel sheets, WhatsApp communication, emails, shared folders, desktop software, and manual reminders to manage their practice operations. As the number of clients increases, managing compliance deadlines, employee coordination, client communication, and document tracking becomes operationally difficult. Firms frequently face issues such as missed due dates, inconsistent workflows, dependency on employees, scattered documentation, lack of visibility into pending work, and inefficient client follow-ups.

The proposed software solves these operational challenges by introducing a centralized digital system where all compliance-related activities are managed through structured workflows, automated task templates, compliance calendars, reminders, document management systems, dashboards, and workflow automation engines.

The platform is designed to support recurring Indian statutory compliances including:

- GST Filings
- Income Tax Filings
- TDS/TCS Filings
- ROC Filings
- PF/ESI Compliances
- Payroll Services
- Audit Workflows
- Certifications
- Notice Management
- Event-Based Compliances

The system will act as the operational backbone of the CA firm by enabling:

- Compliance tracking
- Workflow standardization
- Task automation
- Employee accountability
- Client communication
- Document collection
- Operational reporting
- Due date management
- Workflow visibility

The long-term vision of the product is to become a complete digital operating system for Indian CA firms.

2. Product Vision

The vision of the product is to transform traditional CA firms into digitally managed, process-driven organizations where compliance operations are automated, standardized, scalable, and transparent.

The software aims to become the single operational platform through which firms manage:

- Clients
- Services
- Tasks
- Employees
- Documents
- Filings
- Approvals
- Reports
- Compliance calendars

The platform should reduce dependency on manual coordination and employee memory while increasing operational efficiency, compliance accuracy, scalability, and client satisfaction.

The long-term strategic vision includes:

- End-to-end compliance automation
- AI-assisted compliance workflows
- Government portal integrations
- Smart reconciliation systems
- Automated document extraction
- Intelligent reminders and escalations
- Practice profitability analytics

3. Problem Statement

CA firms currently face multiple operational inefficiencies due to fragmented operational systems and manually managed compliance workflows.

The major operational problems include:

Missed Compliance Deadlines

Government authorities such as GST, Income Tax, MCA, TRACES, EPFO, and ESIC enforce strict filing deadlines. Missing deadlines can result in:

- Late fees
- Penalties
- Interest
- Notices
- Client dissatisfaction
- Reputational damage

Manual tracking through spreadsheets and reminders is unreliable at scale.

Lack of Workflow Standardization

Different employees perform the same compliance activities differently.

Example:

- One employee may reconcile data thoroughly before filing.
- Another employee may directly file returns without validation.

This inconsistency creates operational risks and quality issues.

Poor Visibility Into Operations

Managers and partners often lack real-time visibility into:

- Pending filings
- Overdue tasks
- Employee workload
- Client dependencies
- Filing status
- Escalations

Without centralized dashboards, operational monitoring becomes difficult.

Dependency on Employees

Operational knowledge frequently remains dependent on experienced employees.

If an employee resigns or becomes unavailable:

- workflow continuity suffers
- filing knowledge is lost
- operational delays occur

The software aims to convert organizational workflows into system-driven processes.

Document Collection Challenges

Employees spend significant time following up with clients for:

- invoices
- bank statements
- challans
- audit documents
- tax proofs
- agreements

Document management becomes scattered across:

- WhatsApp
- Email
- Google Drive
- Local folders

The product centralizes document workflows.

4. Product Objectives

The primary objective of the software is to automate recurring compliance management and improve operational efficiency within CA firms.

The system aims to:

- Standardize compliance workflows
- Automate recurring task generation
- Reduce missed due dates
- Improve employee accountability
- Simplify client communication
- Centralize document management
- Improve operational visibility
- Reduce manual coordination
- Improve turnaround time
- Enable firm scalability
- Improve workflow tracking
- Increase compliance accuracy

The product should become the central operational workspace for all stakeholders within the firm.

5. Target Users

The platform is designed for multiple stakeholders operating within the CA ecosystem.

Chartered Accountants / Partners

Partners and firm owners use the platform for:

- operational monitoring
- workflow visibility
- compliance tracking
- business oversight
- employee productivity monitoring
- escalation handling
- reporting

Compliance Managers

Managers use the platform to:

- assign work
- supervise employees
- monitor deadlines
- review filings
- manage escalations
- approve workflows

Employees / Staff

Employees use the platform for:

- task execution
- document collection

- reconciliation
- drafting returns
- filing compliances
- updating statuses
- uploading acknowledgements

Clients

Clients use the platform to:

- upload documents
- view filing status
- approve drafts
- respond to notices
- track pending items

6. Product Scope

The scope of the product includes complete operational workflow management for CA firms.

The platform will include:

- Client Management
- Service Management
- Compliance Tracking
- Task Management
- Workflow Automation
- Task Template Automation
- Document Management
- Notifications & Reminders

- Approval Workflows
- Dashboards & Reporting
- Role-Based Access Control
- Compliance Calendar
- Audit Logs
- Employee Management
- Client Portal

The first version of the product will focus primarily on workflow management and operational automation.

Direct government portal filing integrations may be introduced in future versions.

7. Service Management Module

The Service Management Module acts as the foundation of the application.

The entire compliance workflow system is organized around services offered by the CA firm.

The system should support hierarchical service categorization.

Structure:

Main Service Category → Sub-Service → Workflow Template → Task Automation

The software should support configurable service structures because different CA firms may offer different services.

Main Service Categories

The application should support the following primary service categories:

1. GST
2. IT Filings
3. TDS/TCS Filings
4. Certifications
5. Audits
6. Company Compliance
7. Others

Each category contains multiple sub-services.

GST Services Structure

Under GST, the system should support:

- GSTR-1 Filing
- GSTR-3B Filing
- Monthly GST Filing
- Quarterly GST Filing
- Annual GST Return
- GST Notice Reply
- LUT Filing
- GST Registration
- GST Amendment
- GST Cancellation
- GST Reconciliation
- GST Refund
- Others

The “Others” option should allow firms to dynamically create custom GST services.

Example:

- GST Litigation
- GST Advisory
- GST Appeal Handling

IT Filings Structure

Under IT Filings, the system should support:

- ITR-1
- ITR-2
- ITR-3
- ITR-4
- ITR-5
- ITR-6
- ITR-7
- Revised Return
- Income Tax Notice Reply
- Defective Return Response
- Others

The system should also support Financial Year and Assessment Year tracking.

TDS/TCS Filing Structure

The TDS/TCS category should support:

- TDS Return Filing
- TCS Return Filing
- Form 24Q
- Form 26Q
- Form 27Q

- Form 27EQ
- Correction Return
- TDS Notice Reply
- Others

Certifications Structure

The Certifications category should support:

- Net Worth Certificate
- Turnover Certificate
- Utilization Certificate
- CA Certificate
- Loan Certificate
- Foreign Remittance Certificate
- Others

Audits Structure

The Audits category should support:

- Tax Audit
- Statutory Audit
- Internal Audit
- GST Audit
- Concurrent Audit
- Bank Audit
- Forensic Audit
- Others

Company Compliance Structure

The Company Compliance category should support:

- ROC Annual Filing
- AGM Filing
- AOC-4 Filing
- MGT-7 Filing
- Director KYC
- Auditor Appointment
- Company Incorporation
- INC-20A
- Share Transfer
- DIN Filings
- LLP Annual Filing
- Others

Dynamic Sub-Service Creation

The system should allow firms to dynamically create custom sub-services.

Example:

GST → Add New Sub-Service → “GST Litigation”

The user should be able to configure:

- service name
- frequency
- workflow template
- due date logic
- reminders

- checklists
- document requirements

This ensures flexibility across different CA firms.

8. Task Template Automation Module

The Task Template Automation module is the core operational engine of the software.

The purpose of this module is to automate recurring compliance workflows using reusable workflow templates.

Instead of manually creating compliance tasks every month, quarter, or year, the firm creates reusable templates.

The system automatically generates:

- parent tasks
- subtasks
- due dates
- reminders
- document requests
- escalation workflows

based on configured automation rules.

What is a Task Template?

A Task Template is a predefined workflow blueprint used to automate compliance execution.

A template contains:

- task structure
- subtask definitions
- checklist items
- due date rules
- document requirements
- priorities
- escalation logic
- reminder rules

Example:

A “Monthly GSTR-1 Template” may include:

1. Collect Sales Register
2. Verify GST Invoices
3. Reconcile Data
4. Prepare Draft Return
5. Obtain Client Approval
6. File GSTR-1
7. Download ARN

This same template can be reused across hundreds of clients.

Task Generation Workflow

The automation engine follows this workflow:

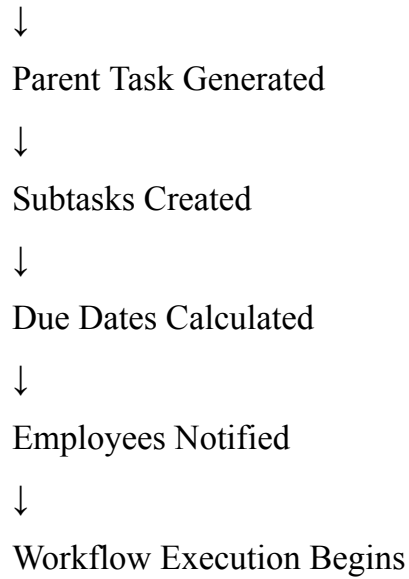
Service(Client Assigned)

↓

Compliance Frequency Detected

↓

Relevant Template Selected



Dynamic Placeholder Logic

The system should support dynamic placeholders.

Supported placeholders include:

- {client_name}
- {service_name}
- {month}
- {year}
- {quarter}
- {fy}
- {period}
- {frequency}

Example Template:

{client_name} – GSTR-1 | {month}

Generated Output:

ABC Pvt Ltd – GSTR-1 | Apr 2026

This allows scalable automation.

Due Date Automation Logic

The system should automatically calculate subtask deadlines based on parent due dates.

Example:

If GSTR-1 due date = 11 May

Then:

- Document Collection = 1 May
- Reconciliation = 4 May
- Draft Preparation = 6 May
- Client Approval = 9 May
- Final Filing = 11 May

The system should support:

- Same Due Date
- Relative Due Date
- Fixed Due Date
- No Due Date

Reminder Automation Logic

The system should automatically send reminders:

- before due date
- on due date
- after overdue

Notifications may be sent through:

- email
- WhatsApp
- SMS
- in-app alerts

Escalation Logic

If tasks remain incomplete after deadlines:

- managers should be notified
- overdue flags should appear
- escalation workflows should activate

This ensures operational accountability.

9. Client Management Module

The Client Management Module acts as the centralized client database.

The system should maintain:

- Client Name
- PAN
- GSTIN
- TAN
- Constitution Type
- Contact Persons
- Email IDs
- Mobile Numbers
- Address
- Assigned Services

- Compliance Applicability

Each client profile should contain:

- tasks
- documents
- filing history
- notices
- billing information

The client profile acts as a centralized workspace.

10. Task Management Module

The Task Management Module manages operational execution.

Every compliance workflow should generate:

- parent tasks
- subtasks
- checklists
- due dates
- dependencies

The system should support:

- task assignment
- task prioritization
- progress tracking
- overdue monitoring
- status management
- dependency tracking

Task Lifecycle

Every task should follow a structured lifecycle.

Draft → Pending → In Progress → Waiting for Client → Under Review → Completed
→ Closed

The system should automatically track task progress.

11. Workflow Management Module

The Workflow Management Module controls operational execution flow.

Each compliance follows structured stages.

Example GST Workflow:

Document Collection



Data Verification



Reconciliation



Draft Preparation



Internal Review



Client Approval



Final Filing

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Acknowledgement Generation

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Closure

The workflow engine ensures process consistency.

12. Document Management Module

The platform should support centralized document storage and retrieval.

The system should allow:

- document uploads
- folder organization
- attachment tagging
- file previews
- version management
- access restrictions

Documents should be linked directly to:

- clients
- services
- tasks
- filings

The module should support:

- PDF
- Excel
- Word

- ZIP
- Images

The system should also track missing documents.

13. Compliance Calendar Module

The Compliance Calendar is responsible for tracking all statutory due dates.

The calendar should support:

- monthly compliances
- quarterly compliances
- annual compliances
- event-based filings

The calendar should display:

- upcoming deadlines
- overdue filings
- completed filings
- client-wise due dates

The system should also support government due date extensions.

14. Notification & Reminder Module

The Notification Module handles automated communication.

The system should send notifications for:

- task assignments
- due date reminders

- overdue alerts
- missing documents
- approval requests
- filing confirmations

Notification channels include:

- email
- SMS
- WhatsApp
- in-app alerts

Reminder frequencies should be configurable.

15. User Roles & Permissions

The platform should support role-based access control.

Primary roles include:

- Super Admin
- Partner
- Compliance Manager
- Employee
- Client

Permissions should determine:

- data visibility
- editing access
- approval authority
- task assignment rights

- reporting access

This ensures operational security.

16. Dashboard & Reporting Module

The system should provide real-time operational dashboards.

The dashboard should display:

- pending compliances
- overdue tasks
- employee workload
- completion rates
- filing statistics
- client-wise reports
- revenue reports

Managers should have firm-wide visibility.

Employees should view assigned operational tasks.

Clients should view compliance status.

17. Non-Functional Requirements

The platform should be:

- cloud-based
- scalable
- secure
- mobile responsive
- high performance

- multi-user capable

Security requirements include:

- encrypted passwords
- secure authentication
- role-based permissions
- audit logs
- session controls
- secure document storage

Performance requirements include:

- fast dashboard loading
- minimal workflow delays
- real-time status updates

18. System Architecture Overview

The platform architecture should follow a modular and scalable structure so that future services, automations, and integrations can be added without affecting existing workflows.

The recommended architecture should include:

Frontend Layer → API Layer → Business Logic Engine → Automation Engine →
Database Layer → Notification Services → File Storage

The frontend layer will handle:

- dashboards
- forms
- task interfaces

- client portal
- workflow screens
- reports

The backend business logic engine will handle:

- workflow execution
- due date calculations
- task generation
- role validation
- automation triggers
- escalation rules

The automation engine will continuously monitor:

- filing schedules
- overdue tasks
- reminder conditions
- workflow dependencies
- pending approvals

The system should support future integration readiness for:

- GST portal
- MCA portal
- TRACES
- Income Tax Portal
- EPFO
- Payment gateways
- WhatsApp APIs
- OCR engines

19. Detailed Workflow Execution Logic

The workflow execution engine is responsible for converting configured templates into operational tasks.

Whenever a service is assigned to a client, the workflow engine should perform the following sequence:

1. Identify applicable service
2. Detect filing frequency
3. Determine applicable compliance period
4. Select mapped workflow template
5. Generate parent task
6. Generate subtasks
7. Calculate due dates
8. Assign users
9. Activate reminders
10. Trigger document requests
11. Begin workflow tracking

Example:

If ABC Pvt Ltd is assigned:

- GSTR-1 Monthly Filing

Then the system should automatically generate:

ABC Pvt Ltd – GSTR-1 | Apr 2026

Under this task:

- Collect Sales Register

- Verify GST Invoices
- Reconcile Data
- Prepare Draft
- Obtain Client Approval
- File GSTR-1
- Download ARN
- Share Filing Confirmation

Each task should contain:

- status
- due date
- checklist
- attachments
- assignees
- comments
- audit logs

The system should continuously monitor workflow progress.

20. Detailed Client Portal Requirements

The Client Portal is a dedicated interface through which clients interact with the CA firm.

The objective of the portal is to reduce manual communication and improve transparency.

Clients should be able to:

- upload documents
- view pending requests
- track compliance status
- approve filings

- download acknowledgements
- respond to notices
- view filing history
- communicate with the assigned team

The client dashboard should clearly display:

- upcoming due dates
- pending document requests
- overdue submissions
- completed filings
- notices requiring action

The document upload interface should support:

- drag-and-drop upload
- mobile uploads
- multiple file upload
- document categorization
- upload progress tracking

The portal should also maintain activity history.

Example:

- document uploaded by client
- approval granted
- notice responded
- acknowledgment downloaded

The client experience should remain extremely simple because many clients may not be technically advanced.

21. Employee Workspace Requirements

The Employee Workspace acts as the operational execution dashboard.

Employees should see:

- assigned tasks
- upcoming deadlines
- overdue items
- pending approvals
- document requests
- workload summary

The employee interface should prioritize operational clarity.

Each task screen should display:

- task title
- client details
- due date
- subtasks
- checklists
- comments
- required documents
- linked compliances
- activity history

Employees should be able to:

- update status
- upload files
- add comments

- request documents
- escalate issues
- mark checklist items complete

The system should also support workload balancing.

Managers should be able to monitor:

- task completion rates
- employee productivity
- overdue workload
- pending assignments

22. Detailed Compliance Calendar Requirements

The Compliance Calendar is one of the most important operational components of the system.

The calendar should maintain all statutory due dates applicable to the firm's clients.

The system should support:

- monthly compliances
- quarterly compliances
- annual compliances
- event-based compliances

Examples include:

- GSTR-1
- GSTR-3B
- TDS Returns
- ROC Filings

- PF Returns
- ESI Returns
- Income Tax Filings
- Director KYC
- Auditor Appointments

The calendar should dynamically calculate due dates based on:

- filing frequency
- applicable period
- government notifications
- extensions
- weekends and holidays

The compliance calendar dashboard should support:

- day-wise view
- month-wise view
- compliance-wise filtering
- client-wise filtering
- overdue highlighting
- upcoming deadline indicators

Managers should be able to identify operational risks quickly.

23. Detailed Document Management Requirements

The Document Management System should centralize all compliance-related files.

Every document uploaded into the system should be linked to:

- client

- service
- compliance
- task
- workflow stage

The system should support:

- secure uploads
- cloud storage
- folder management
- file categorization
- document preview
- version control
- access restrictions
- expiry tracking

The software should maintain document history.

Example:

- uploaded by
- uploaded date
- modified date
- version number
- linked compliance

Document categories may include:

- GST documents
- tax documents
- ROC documents
- payroll documents

- notices
- challans
- acknowledgements
- agreements
- certificates

The system should also support document request workflows.

Example:

Employee requests:

- Sales Register
- Purchase Register
- Bank Statement

Client uploads pending documents directly through the portal.

24. Billing & Invoicing Module

The software should include billing and invoicing functionality for CA firms.

The purpose of this module is to help firms manage:

- service billing
- recurring invoices
- payment tracking
- client receivables
- outstanding amounts

Invoices may be linked to:

- recurring compliances

- event-based services
- audit assignments
- certification work

The system should support:

- fixed fee billing
- recurring billing
- one-time billing
- milestone-based billing

Each invoice should include:

- client details
- service details
- tax calculations
- payment status
- due date

The software should support:

- invoice generation
- PDF export
- payment reminders
- GST-compliant invoices
- outstanding tracking

Future versions may support payment gateway integrations.

25. Internal Communication & Notes Module

The software should include an internal communication system to reduce dependency on WhatsApp and external communication channels.

Employees and managers should be able to:

- add internal notes
- tag team members
- discuss task issues
- escalate blockers
- record observations

Comments should remain linked directly to tasks and subtasks.

The system should maintain communication history.

This improves auditability and workflow transparency.

26. Approval Workflow Module

Many compliance processes require approval before filing.

The system should support multi-stage approvals.

Approval stages may include:

- employee review
- manager review
- partner approval
- client approval

Example workflow:

Draft Return Prepared



Manager Review



Client Approval



Final Filing

The system should prevent filing until mandatory approvals are completed.

Approval logs should capture:

- approver name
- timestamp
- approval remarks
- rejection reason

27. Audit Logs & Activity Tracking

The software should maintain detailed audit logs for operational transparency.

Every system activity should be recorded.

Examples include:

- task creation
- status updates
- document uploads
- approvals
- reassignment
- deletions
- workflow changes

The activity log should capture:

- user name
- action performed
- date and time
- affected entity

Audit logs improve:

- accountability
- operational tracking
- compliance monitoring
- dispute resolution

28. Data Security & Access Control

Since the platform stores highly sensitive financial and statutory data, security is critical.

The platform should implement:

- role-based access control
- encrypted password storage
- secure authentication
- session expiration
- access restrictions
- secure file storage
- audit logging
- backup systems

Client data should remain isolated and protected.

Only authorized users should access confidential records.

The system should support:

- user-level permissions
- department-level restrictions
- document visibility control
- restricted workflow access

29. Scalability Requirements

The platform should support scalability across:

- multiple offices
- large client bases
- large employee teams
- multiple service categories
- growing compliance volumes

The architecture should support:

- modular feature additions
- workflow customization
- large task volumes
- concurrent users
- future integrations

The system should remain performant even with:

- thousands of clients
- lakhs of tasks
- large document repositories
-

30. Mobile Responsiveness Requirements

The software should be fully responsive across:

- desktop
- tablet
- mobile devices

Employees and clients should be able to:

- view tasks
- upload documents
- approve filings
- receive reminders
- update statuses

from mobile devices.

Future versions may include dedicated mobile applications.

31. Key Success Metrics

The success of the product should be measured through operational and business KPIs.

Key success indicators include:

- reduction in missed deadlines
- faster task completion
- improved employee productivity
- reduced manual coordination
- improved client satisfaction
- increased workflow visibility
- reduction in overdue tasks

- faster document collection cycles

The software should help firms scale operations without proportionally increasing operational overhead.

32. Assumptions & Constraints

The product assumes that:

- CA firms follow recurring compliance workflows
- users possess basic computer literacy
- firms are willing to adopt digital processes
- internet access is available

Constraints include:

- government APIs may not always be available
- compliance rules frequently change
- workflows differ across firms
- some clients may resist portal adoption

The product architecture should therefore remain highly configurable.

33. Conclusion

The CA Practice Management Software is intended to modernize and digitize compliance operations for Indian CA firms.

The platform transforms manually managed operational activities into structured, automated, scalable digital workflows.

By combining:

- compliance tracking
- workflow automation
- task template systems
- client management
- document management
- reminder systems
- dashboards
- approval workflows
- operational reporting

The software becomes the central operating system for the CA firm.

The product is designed not merely as a task manager but as a complete workflow automation and compliance management platform capable of supporting the long-term operational growth of Indian Chartered Accountant firms.